EKATERINA DEYS

Payment Partnerships at PayDo — my first 90 days

Senior/Lead Payment Partnerships Manager · Remote, Europe · katedeys@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kate-deys

Written from the outside, from the job description and how partner networks usually look at an EMI serving digital and higher-risk merchants. Every point is a hypothesis to check against PayDo's data and pipeline in the first two weeks. The idea underneath: treat the partner network as a product, with a coverage map, a scorecard per partner and a roadmap of what to add, renegotiate or replace.

HOW I WOULD MEASURE THE PARTNER NETWORK

Metric	Why it matters
Coverage gaps	Countries, currencies, payment methods and industries merchants ask for that no live partner can serve within PayDo's risk appetite.
Time from first contact to live	How fast a new bank, PSP or APM starts processing; usually lost in KYB and integration hand-offs.
Cost and performance per partner	Fees, approval or success rate, uptime and settlement speed. The data that wins renegotiations.
Concentration risk	Share of volume per partner in each corridor or vertical; one partner leaving should never stop a merchant segment.
Pipeline health	Partners in discovery, KYB, contract and integration, with a target date for each.

DAYS 1–30 · MAP THE NETWORK

Outcome: one shared picture of who we work with, where we are thin and what each partner costs.

- Build a coverage map of every live correspondent bank, PSP, acquirer and APM: geographies, currencies, methods, industries, risk appetite, contract and KYB renewal dates.
- Start a partner scorecard from transaction data: fees, approval and success rates, incidents, settlement times. Agree it with Finance, Risk and Product.
- Collect demand: which merchant segments Sales loses because a corridor or method is missing; list the top gaps by revenue at stake.
- Learn the KYB/AML onboarding path with Compliance and Legal, and where it usually stalls.

DAYS 31–60 · CLOSE THE BIGGEST GAPS

Outcome: the top gaps have named partner candidates in the pipeline, and the first renegotiations are running.

- Shortlist and approach partners for the 2–3 most valuable gaps, with a second option for every corridor that depends on a single provider.
- Open fee reviews with the largest partners, backed by scorecard benchmarks. At inDrive and SkyRo this data-first approach is what got us better terms.
- A standard onboarding playbook: commercial terms, KYB pack, technical checklist and test plan agreed with Compliance and Engineering. At SkyRo a standard flow cut partner go-live to 2.5 weeks.
- Support re-onboarding of providers under new licences, prioritised by volume at risk.

DAYS 61–90 · MAKE IT REPEATABLE

Outcome: a partner roadmap for H1 and a monthly rhythm with management.

- First new partners live or in final integration; renegotiated terms signed where the data supported it.
- Monthly partner review: scorecard, pipeline, renewals due, market and regulatory changes, with clear add, keep, renegotiate or exit decisions.
- Work with Product and Engineering on what PayDo's APIs need for faster partner integrations and smarter routing between partners.

WHAT I BRING TO THIS

- **The partner side of payments, from the merchant chair:** chose, negotiated with, onboarded and managed PSPs, EMIs, acquirers and banks at inDrive (40 countries) and SkyRo.
- **Data-first negotiation:** provider benchmarks on cost, approval and technical performance; routing on cost and coverage saved ~$100K/month.
- **Onboarding that doesn't stall:** one integration contract and flow for new partners (2.5 weeks each), Virtual IBAN issuance with a partner bank, PCI DSS Service Provider certification with Compliance.

Questions I would bring to the first week: which corridors and verticals drive most volume and most lost deals; where single-partner dependency is highest; how long KYB with a new bank takes today; which licences and jurisdictions are next. Correspondent banking and SWIFT corridors are where I would invest time first.